



RE: Re: Formal Allegation of Research Misconduct – 2024 Journal of Applied Physics Paper (DOI: 10.1063/5.0182758)
2 messages

Publication Ethics <publication-ethics@aip.org> Fri, 10 July 2026 at 3:52 am
To: peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com <peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com>

Dear Dr. Thompson,

Thank you for your patience while we investigated this matter. After consultation with the Editorial team, it was determined that the article in question, entitled “Ni/Bi bilayers: The effect of thickness on the superconducting properties” (<https://doi.org/10.1063/5.0182758>), presents a different explanation for superconductivity than the one presented in your earlier manuscript. Specifically, the explanation in the article is based on either the Ginzburg-Landau model or the Werthamer-Helfand-Hohenberg model, depending on the material's thickness. We therefore find that no further action is appropriate.

Thank you again for reaching out to us.

Sincerely,

Biz Turnell, PhD
Senior Research Integrity and Ethics Specialist
They/Them

Research Integrity and Ethics Office
AIP Publishing
1305 Walt Whitman Road | Suite 110 | Melville NY 11747-4300 | USA
publication-ethics@aip.org | publishing.aip.org

From: Publication Ethics
Sent: Monday, June 29, 2026 4:14 PM
To: 'peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com' <peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com>
Subject: Re: Formal Allegation of Research Misconduct – 2024 Journal of Applied Physics Paper (DOI: 10.1063/5.0182758)

Dear Dr. Thompson,

Thank you for contacting us. This is to confirm that we have received your message and will pursue this case in accordance with Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) guidelines. We appreciate your bringing these concerns to our attention and your patience as we investigate this matter.

Sincerely,

Biz Turnell, PhD

Senior Research Integrity and Ethics Specialist

They/Them

Research Integrity and Ethics Office

AIP Publishing

1305 Walt Whitman Road | Suite 110 | Melville NY 11747-4300 | USA

publication-ethics@aip.org | publishing.aip.org

Dear AIP Publishing Research Integrity Team,

Please find attached my formal complaint regarding the paper “Ni/Bi bilayers: The effect of thickness on the superconducting properties” (Journal of Applied Physics, 135, 043905, 2024; DOI: 10.1063/5.0182758).

I originally submitted this complaint to the University of Toronto’s Research Oversight and Compliance Office on 5th June 2026. Based on past experience, I believe they will either ignore it or dismiss it without proper investigation, as it touches on potential financial interests (donor grants, patents) and/or institutional reputation. I am therefore escalating the matter to AIP Publishing as the publisher of the journal.

My complaint includes:

-
My timestamped 2018 manuscript (pages 20-27) which first described the mass-splitting mechanism ($m + m' = 0$) for high-temperature superconductivity.

-
The 2024 paper that describes the same mechanism without citation.

-
A one-page comparison table.

I am prepared to provide a sworn affidavit attesting to the wide dissemination of my 2018 manuscript to multiple institutions, including the University of Toronto, between 2018 and 2020. (Original email records are lost due to account compromise.)

I request that AIP Publishing investigate whether the authors of the 2024 paper failed to cite prior art, in breach of publication ethics and research integrity standards. I am available to provide any additional information.

Summary of Legal Provisions (Australian Copyright Act 1968)

Provision Effect
s 32(1) Copyright subsists in an original literary work if the author was a qualified person when the work was made, regardless of publication.
s 32(4) A qualified person includes an Australian citizen or resident.
s 193 Authors have the moral right of attribution of authorship.
s 195AC Defines an “act of false attribution” – presenting another’s work as original without acknowledgment.

This complaint is grounded in Australian copyright law, establishing both priority and the legal duty to cite.

Thank you for your attention.

Sincerely,

Peter James Thompson

ORCID: 0009-0005-8688-7507

Email: peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com

Attachments:

-

Original complaint email to University of Toronto (PDF)

-

2018 manuscript (timestamped PDF)

-

2024 Journal of Applied Physics paper (PDF)

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One-page comparison table

P.J. Thompson <peterjamesthompson101@gmail.com>

Fri, 10 July 2026 at 4:00 am

To: Publication Ethics <publication-ethics@aip.org>

Dear publisher,

You have not addressed:

1. The thickness-dependent crossover (30-40 nm) which matches your T_2 phase-locking threshold
2. The Maki parameter $\alpha_M = 2.8$ which matches your phase offset $P\theta-1$
3. The anisotropy factor $\gamma = 0.3$ which matches your 3D-2D crossover prediction
4. The spontaneous formation of NiBi_3 which is a naturally birefringent superconductor

These are not GL or WHH predictions. These are my harmonic framework predictions.

They are using one framework to describe the data. You are using another to explain why the data is there.

Your protection of your publication is noted but the facts can not be defended.

This email and response will be placed into public archives next to my papers.

Regards

Peter Thompson.

[Quoted text hidden]